

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S)

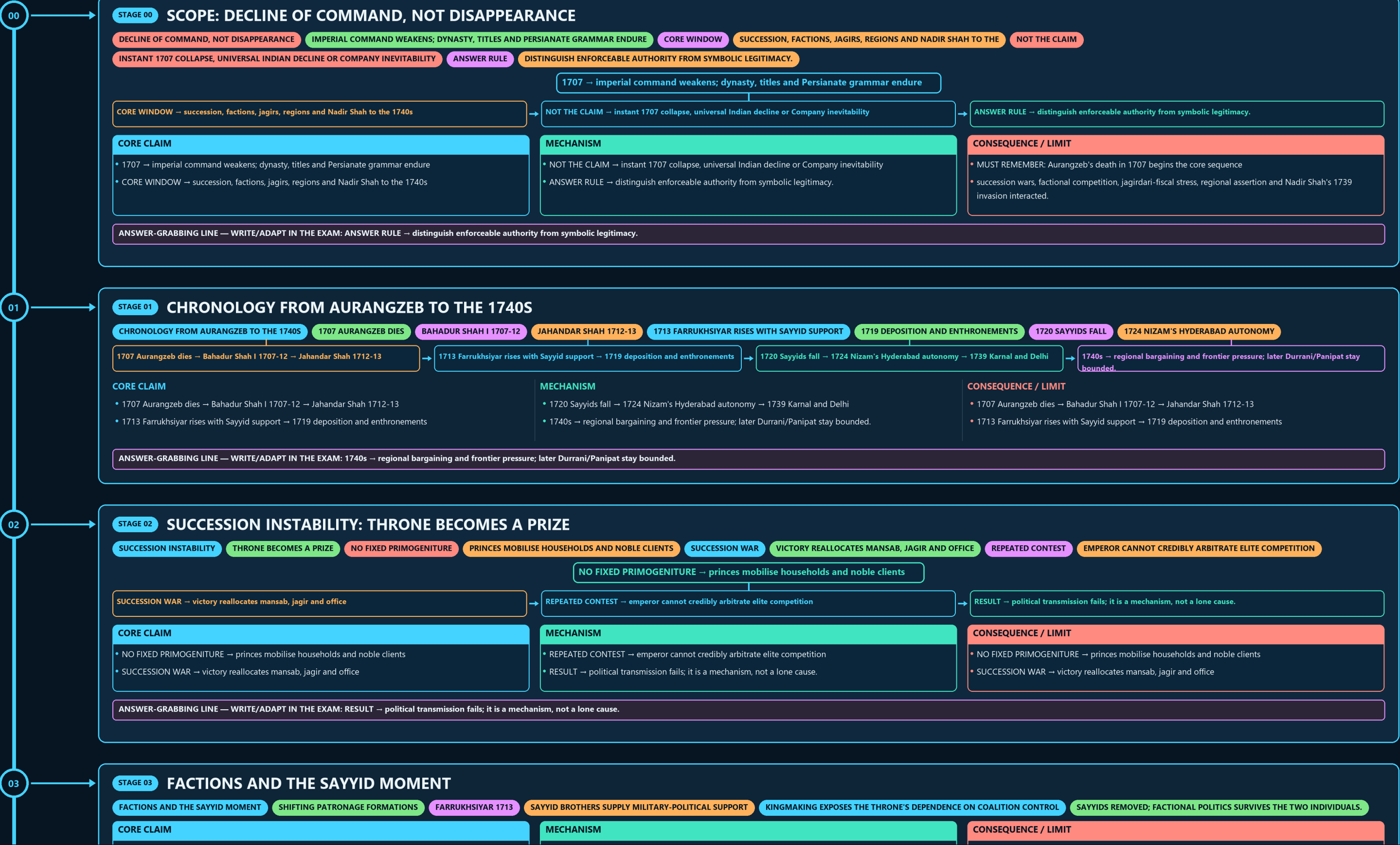
SCOPE: DECLINE OF COMMAND → CHRONOLOGY FROM AURANGZEB TO → SUCCESSION INSTABILITY: THRONE BECOMES → FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID → JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY → FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

CORE CLAIM

- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

MECHANISM

- REPEATED CONTEST → emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
- RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE → princes mobilise households and noble clients
- SUCCESSION WAR → victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

04

STAGE 03

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT

FACTIONS AND THE SAYYID MOMENT

SHIFTING PATRONAGE FORMATIONS

FARRUKHSIYAR 1713

SAYYID BROTHERS SUPPLY MILITARY-POLITICAL SUPPORT

KINGMAKING EXPOSES THE THRONE'S DEPENDENCE ON COALITION CONTROL

SAYYIDS REMOVED; FACTIONAL POLITICS SURVIVES THE TWO INDIVIDUALS.

CORE CLAIM

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

MECHANISM

- 1719 → kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control
- 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI → shifting patronage formations
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1720 → Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

05

STAGE 04

JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY ERRORS

JAGIRDARI VOCABULARY PREVENTS CATEGORY ERRORS

TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT, NOT PRIVATE LANDOWNERSHIP

ASSESSED CLAIM

REALISED COLLECTION

RESERVE ASSIGNABLE POOL

USABLE JAGIR SHORTAGE

NOMINAL ASSESSMENT NEVER AUTOMATICALLY MEASURES TREASURY CASH OR WELFARE.

JAMA → assessed claim	HASIL → realised collection
PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool	BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage

CORE CLAIM

- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment, not private landownership
- JAMA → assessed claim

MECHANISM

- HASIL → realised collection
- PAIBAQI → reserve assignable pool

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BE-JAGIRI → usable jagir shortage
- TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

06

STAGE 05

FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

FISCAL-MILITARY FEEDBACK LOOP

MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI

SCRAMBLE FOR PRODUCTIVE JAGIRS

SHORT TENURE

RESISTANCE, EVASION, FLIGHT OR NEGOTIATION

LOWER HASIL

UNPAID CONTINGENTS AND WEAKER IMPERIAL SERVICE

WEAKER CONTROL

MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs

→

SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

→

LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service

→

WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CORE CLAIM

- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

MECHANISM

- LOWER HASIL → unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service
- WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI → scramble for productive jagirs
- SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION → resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAKER CONTROL → regional retention of revenue → still lower central capacity.

07

STAGE 06

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY: A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY

A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

DECCAN WAR

GARRISONS, TRANSPORT, REMOUNTS AND UNRESOLVED MARATHA CHALLENGE

TERRITORY AND CLAIMS GROW FASTER THAN RELIABLE REALISATION

NORTH ABSENCE

STRAINS OF SUPERVISION AND ARBITRATION

LEGACY MATTERED, BUT AURANGZEB ALONE CANNOT EXPLAIN POST-1707 FACTIONS

ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

→

DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

→

NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration

→

QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CORE CLAIM

- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

MECHANISM

- NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration
- QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge
- ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S) • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2533-5767 of 10832 • continues below

06

STAGE 06

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY: A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

AURANGZEB'S LEGACY

A WEIGHTED BACKGROUND

DECCAN WAR

GARRISONS, TRANSPORT, REMOUNTS AND UNRESOLVED MARATHA CHALLENGE

TERRITORY AND CLAIMS GROW FASTER THAN RELIABLE REALISATION

NORTH ABSENCE

STRAINS OF SUPERVISION AND ARBITRATION

LEGACY MATTERED, BUT AURANGZEB ALONE CANNOT EXPLAIN POST-1707 FACTIONS

ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration

QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CORE CLAIM

• DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

• ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

MECHANISM

• NORTH ABSENCE → strains of supervision and arbitration

• QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• DECCAN WAR → garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

• ANNEXATIONS → territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

07

STAGE 07

AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION

AGRARIAN AND REGIONAL ASSERTION

REVENUE PRESSURE

ZAMINDARS, PEASANTS AND INTERMEDIARIES BARGAIN OR RESIST

GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS

PROVINCIAL RESOURCE CONTROL

JAT MOBILISATION

DISTINCT POLITICAL ROUTES, NOT ONE REBELLION

DELHI'S WEAKENING AND REGIONAL STATE-MAKING REINFORCE EACH OTHER.

GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control

REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist

MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation → distinct political routes, not one rebellion

RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

CORE CLAIM

• REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist

• GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control

MECHANISM

• MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation → distinct political routes, not one rebellion

• RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• REVENUE PRESSURE → zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist

• GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS → provincial resource control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

08

STAGE 08

SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM

SUCCESSOR-STATE SPECTRUM

MURSHID QULI KHAN

SAADAT KHAN

IMPERIAL OFFICE

LOCAL REVENUE, ARMY AND PATRONAGE BECOME DURABLE

FORMAL MUGHAL LEGITIMACY MAY REMAIN USEFUL

AUTONOMY IN SUBSTANCE DOES NOT REQUIRE A MODERN DECLARATION

CORE CLAIM

• BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan

• AWADH → Saadat Khan

MECHANISM

• HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk

• IMPERIAL OFFICE → local revenue, army and patronage become durable

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• COIN / KHUTBA / TITLE → formal Mughal legitimacy may remain useful

• TRAP → autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

09

STAGE 09

NADIR SHAH: SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS

NADIR SHAH

SHOCK EXPOSES A PRIOR CRISIS

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + PERSIAN MILITARY CAPACITY

INVASION OPPORTUNITY

KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739

FRAGMENTED COMMAND LOSES TO UNIFIED COMMAND

SACK, TREASURY LOSS AND PRESTIGE SHOCK; MUHAMMAD SHAH REMAINS

ACCELERANT AND REVEALER, NOT THE ORIGINAL CAUSE OF DECLINE.

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity

KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor

VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse

CORE CLAIM

• FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity

• KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

MECHANISM

• DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor

• VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse,

• civilisational decline or disappearance of Mughal titles, revenue forms and Persianate legitimacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

10

STAGE 10

INSTITUTIONAL CONTINUITY AFTER CONTRACTION

DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S) • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5065-8299 of 10832 • continues below

ACCELERANT AND REVEALER, NOT THE ORIGINAL CAUSE OF DECLINE.

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity

KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor

VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse

CORE CLAIM

FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity → invasion opportunity
KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 → fragmented command loses to unified command

MECHANISM

DELHI → sack, treasury loss and prestige shock; Muhammad Shah remains emperor
VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse,
civilisational decline or disappearance of Mughal titles, revenue forms and Persianate legitimacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.

10

STAGE 10

INSTITUTIONAL CONTINUITY AFTER CONTRACTION

INSTITUTIONAL CONTINUITY AFTER CONTRACTION
SYMBOLIC ARBITRATION AND LEGAL VOCABULARY
COIN + KHUTBA
LAYERED LEGITIMACY
PERSIAN CHANCERY
PORTABLE ADMINISTRATION
INSTITUTIONS REPURPOSED IN REGIONAL ARENAS
CONTINUITY OF FORM COEXISTS WITH CHANGE IN WHO COMMANDS

COIN + KHUTBA → layered legitimacy

EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD → symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary

PERSIAN CHANCERY → portable administration

MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR → institutions repurposed in regional arenas

CORE CLAIM

EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD → symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary
COIN + KHUTBA → layered legitimacy
PERSIAN CHANCERY → portable administration

MECHANISM

MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR → institutions repurposed in regional arenas
RULE → continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Satish Chandra's jagirdari analysis, regional-state evidence and court chronicles must be compared

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

no single-ruler or British-inevitability thesis is sufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 01 ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 01 ANSWER SPINE
CENTRAL FISCAL-MILITARY COMMAND DECLINED INSIDE A CONTINUING POLITICAL CULTURE
SUCCESSION + FACTION + JAGIR-AGRARIAN STRAIN + REGIONAL ASSERTION
DECCAN LEGACY MATTERS; REJECT AURANGZEB-ONLY MONOCAUSALITY
NADIR 1739 EXPOSES WEAKNESS; CONTINUITY AND REGIONAL VARIATION QUALIFY
STOP CORE CHRONOLOGY IN THE 1740S.

OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture

EXPLAIN → succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion

WEIGH → Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality

TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion

CLOSE → stop core chronology in the 1740s.

CORE CLAIM

OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture
EXPLAIN → succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion

MECHANISM

WEIGH → Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality
TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE → stop core chronology in the 1740s.
OPEN → central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST → Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT
THE DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE (1707–1740S) — ADVANCED
1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA
2. KEY CLASSIFICATION
3. STUDY LINKS
4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)
5. UPSC TRAPS
6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707–1740s) — ADVANCED
Mini-timeline
1. Snapshot & core idea
2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

3. Study links
4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
5. UPSC Traps
6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

7. Mains angles
+ Historiography note (PYQ-gap)
Bipin Chandra frames decline as structural , not merely a matter of "bad kings": the jagirdari and agrarian crisis was central.
The number of nobles (mansabdars) and their claims outran the supply of revenue-yielding jagirs , producing a scramble

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.